



3 new phones

LG launches the GB270, KP265 and GB210 cellphones for Rs. 4,599, 4,999 and 4,399 respectively



Mac Office

Microsoft has rolled out another major update to Office 2008 for Mac that it's calling Service Pack 2

LCD Monitor Test

20-inch monitors – between rock bottom and a larger screen

20-inch displays are the big boys of yesteryear. Before the coming of the 22-inch monitor there was a time when the 20-inch wide screen monitor ruled supreme. As kings of the LCD monitor domain these displays had a resolution of 1680 x 1050 pixels, which was way higher than widescreen 19-inch monitors that could manage only 1440 x 900 pixels. 22-inch monitors have the same resolution as the 20-inch displays but offer a bigger screen. These have found a wide fan base with gamers and movie aficionados. Most 22-inch monitors sport very cheap TN panels and these monitors have been the catalysts of the price crash, but a few of the smaller, less popular 20-inch displays are still available.

Features

Dell's ST2010 is a neat looking monitor that has a narrow piano-black finished bezel; the rear is piano white and gently rounded, giving it a very Apple-like look. Build quality is good, but the stand is very mediocre. Acer's P205H has a glossy LCD panel and is neat looking with a piano black finish and a decent looking bezel. It's also pretty slim though not anywhere as slim as a WLED display. AOC's 2036Sa is another neat looker with a reasonably slim bezel. The stand is oval shaped with a simplistic look but well finished in glossy black; its

tilt mechanism is stiff. Intex' IT-2002W is a well-built LCD with a steadier stand than the 22-inch Intex 2202TVP; build quality is good, though the surface finish is a simplistic smooth black. Weirdly, all these 20-inch displays supported the ultra widescreen 16:9 viewing format and their resolution was identical at 1600 x 900 pixels apiece.

Performance

Intex' IT-2002W has good brightness levels and a decent enough contrast to make movies a fun experience, but we'd like a wider colour gamut; this is also one of the reasons why Display Mate wasn't kind to this panel, with some mediocre scores. Dell's ST2010 was the best 20-inch display when it came to gaming – good colour, a decent contrast ratio that allowed good detailing under *Crysis*. The only test where it lagged behind was the 256-shade ramp where we found the higher intensities and extreme lower intensities tended to blend noticeably. Both Acer's P205H and AOC's 2036Sa had issues in the reverse text tests, where white on a yellow background and cyan on a green background were nearly

impossible to read. A couple of other colour combinations are also barely discernable. The P205H did well in the gaming tests, especially *Crysis* where good weapon and suit details were visible. Its viewing angles are also pretty good for a TN panel and it did well in the movie tests.

As for the 2036Sa from AOC, it wasn't too hot. Firstly, the reds seem compressed in some videos with visible noise. In the 16-shade intensity ramp the pinks, greys and greens have a problem at the highest intensities where the two highest intensity colours seem to merge – this



AOC F19

problem is visible with all the other colours as well though it's not as severe. Colour breadth for red and blue was not as wide as we'd like. As a result, we didn't like the experience when playing *Crysis* on this display.

Conclusion

Acer's P205H emerges as our Best Buy – it's a good all-round performer at a sweet price. Rs. 7,500 is a good price point and until a year ago you would only get you a 19-inch CRT monitor. In fact, with the exception of the Dell ST2010 (Rs. 8,900) all the other monitors were pretty affordable. The Dell might be worth a look if you want something for gaming, but to be honest, if you could spend a bit more and pick up a 22-inch display, you'd also have a lot more variety.

19-inch monitors – Fresh minnows

These monitors represent, for us, the minimum size bracket you should look at. Some people protest saying they only want to surf and will never need a bigger screen – a common statement and also one that is most often proven wrong. There's nothing like "enough" when it comes to screen size. Since the only way to interface with your PC is by what you see on-screen, ultimately no paltry 15-inch display will satisfy for very long. Even if you're not a gamer or a movie junkie eventually every PC user craves for more viewable real estate and today's websites are also rich enough with multimedia content to advocate a larger display.

Features

Of the six 19-inch monitors we tested three had weird resolutions of 1366 x 768 pixels – this resolution is more used on 26- and 32-inch LCD TVs. This also allows these monitors to natively support 720p (1280 x 720 pixels) content. These were two models from AOC and the Samsung SyncMaster D190. The ViewSonic VA1928wm was the only monitor to support a 16:10 aspect ratio and a resolution of 1440 x 900 pixels. The other two NEC displays had resolutions of 1280 x 1024 pixels and were clearly aimed at business, medical and industry segments with their high-end panels, superb build quality and fully functional (rotate,

Contact Sheet LCD Monitor Comparison Test

Brands	Phone No	Email	Website
AOC	91-124-280 6116 / 17	info@in.aocmonitor.com	www.aoc.com
Acer	011-26734300	varshas@perfectrelations.com	www.acer.co.in
ASUS	022 - 67668800	media_india@asus.com	www.in.asus.com
Dell	1-800-425-4026, 080-25068026	dell_enquiries@dell.com	www.dell.co.in
HP	9811626585	mansi.pal@bm.com	welcome.hp.com/country/in/en/welcome.htm
Intex	1800116789 (toll free); 011-41610224, 26	info@intextechnologies.com	www.intextechnologies.com
LG	0120-2560900/40	Sanjoy@lgindia.com	www.lgindia.com
NEC	011-30822112	info@shibacomp.com	www.shibacomp.com
Samsung	011-4151 1234	m.malhotra@samsung.com	www.samsung.com/in
ViewSonic	022 2668 1921	Umang@rooponline.com	www.in.viewsonic.com